

be used to allow certain people access to the blog, and restrict the rest.

Xanga is the only one of the blog hosts here that allowed a backup of the posts to be made. Free users are limited to online backups, while paid users can download the backups.

Concluding Remarks

While Xanga offers just as much as Live Journal, the fact that the choice of templates is limited makes it comparatively unattractive. The user cannot be expected to make up for this shortfall by creating his own templates with knowledge of HTML and CSS. Xanga is not targeted at a serious blogger, rather to a community blogger. The site, like LiveJournal, offers blogging as another activity to be shared with acquaintances.

1.10.6 Other Platforms and Hosts

Movable Type

This is a proprietary blogging platform from the owners of Live Journal—Six Apart. Since free hosted versions are not available, we cannot offer a first hand review. However, the platform is free for personal use and can be freely downloaded, but needs to be installed on a Web server and configured to work along with Perl and MySQL before it can be used. This cannot be done without relevant knowledge of PHP, MySQL and Web server administration. Six Apart offers the hosted version of Moveable Type at Typepad.com, but here a free Trial is available only after signing up with Credit Card details.

Moveable Type is regarded as an excellent blogging platform. A list of features is available here: <http://www.sixapart.com/movabletype/versions-and-features.html>. It can be downloaded here: <http://www.sixapart.com/movabletype/pricing.html>.

If you are serious about finding an ideal blogging platform, it would be behoved of you to test Moveable Type before coming to a conclusion. You can use one of the many free webhosts that support MySQL and Perl to test the platform.